

## Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·  
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

31 August 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

The paralegal role at SGN's Legal Services team appeals to me because it sits at the intersection of regulatory work, public-interest obligations and a variety of legal practice areas, which matches how I have built my experience so far. My background spans complex disputes at BCLP, data privacy advisory work at Q-Legal, and ongoing casework at Citizens Advice, where the legal issues shift between employment, housing, welfare and debt on a daily basis. That breadth, rather than deep specialism in one area, is what I have actively sought out.

At BCLP I spent a year supporting two distinct teams. In international arbitration I became the only junior on a complex investment arbitration shortly before a significant deadline. I tracked outstanding actions, coordinated documents and liaised with the client and an external translator to ensure on-time submission. In real estate disputes I prepared electronic hearing bundles, maintained matter records on iManage and supported skeleton arguments across several matters running simultaneously. Both rotations required close attention to deadlines and accurate file management under pressure, which is directly relevant to the case management responsibilities in this role.

At Citizens Advice I take detailed factual statements, identify evidential gaps, draft correspondence and manage matters from instruction through to submission. Clients frequently come in with problems that touch more than one area of law, so I need to assess what is legally relevant quickly and translate complex statutory rules into guidance they can actually act on. Working across welfare benefits, employment, housing and debt in that way has developed the kind of broad legal awareness that a general in-house team like SGN's Legal Services requires. It has also reinforced how seriously I take accuracy and confidentiality when handling sensitive client information.

SGN's Legal Services team handling matters from regulatory compliance through to property and employment within a single function is the kind of environment where I would develop most usefully at this stage. The public-service dimension of the work, supporting a network that supplies gas to homes and businesses, adds a layer of accountability that I find genuinely motivating rather than incidental. I am confident my experience managing competing deadlines, supporting substantive legal work and communicating clearly with clients and stakeholders makes me a strong candidate for this role.

Yours sincerely,  
Maria Silva